

ARTISTIC GYMNASTICS

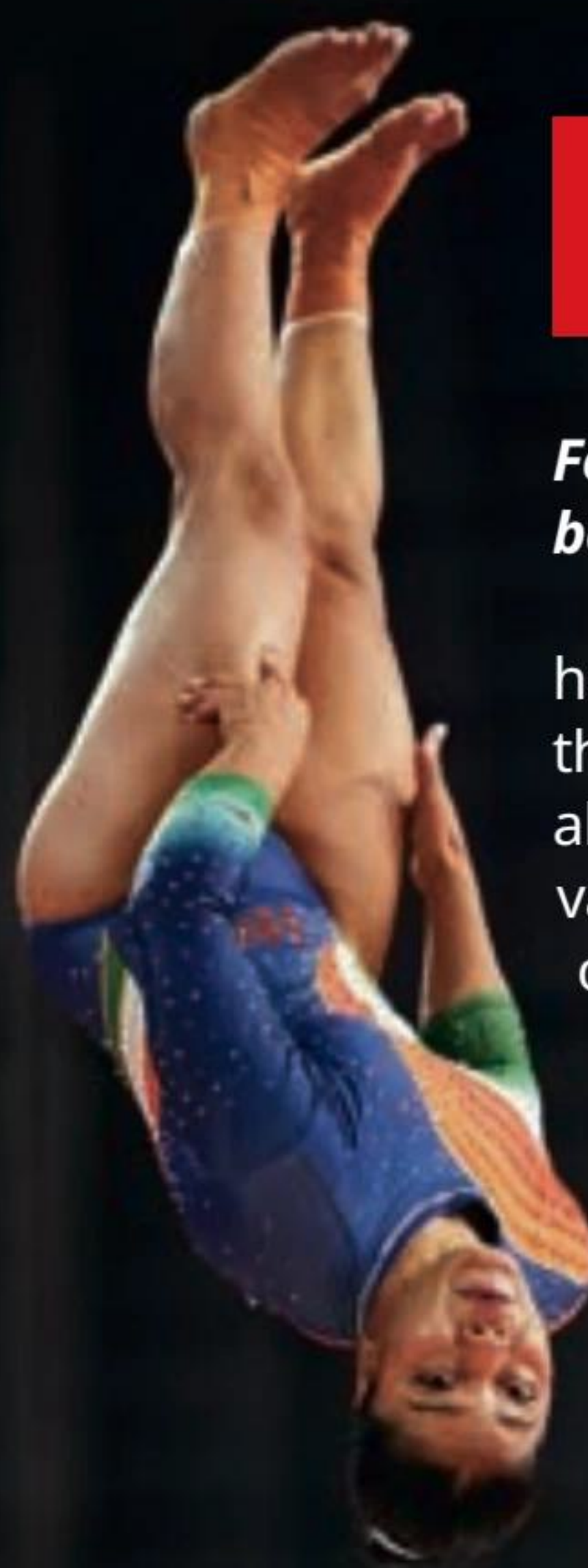
Indian contingent



Pranati Nayak (Women's Vault, Women's All-Around)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

42



For the second edition in a row, Pranati Nayak (in pic) will be the only Indian gymnast at the Asian Games.

The 31-year-old from Jhargram in West Bengal made her continental debut in 2014. In every campaign since then, she has qualified for an individual final — the all-around final in 2014, where she finished 20th, and the vault finals in 2018 and 2022, where she finished eighth on both occasions.

A three-time bronze medallist in vault at the Asian Championships, Pranati did not have the best start to the 2026 season. An ankle injury in December, interrupted training and illness kept her off the mat.

But she returned to competition in May and promptly won silver at the FIG World Challenge Cup in Tashkent. At the Asian Championships, she finished seventh, while at the Commonwealth Games she failed to qualify for the final.

In Aichi-Nagoya, her first objective will be to avoid a repeat of the mistakes from

Glasgow before chasing a podium finish — something no Indian woman has achieved at the Asian Games.

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Indian contingent



Deepu Mallesh (Men's Speed 4),
Joga Purty (Women's Speed 4)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

18

Indian climbers have competed at the Asian Games since the sport was introduced at the 2018

edition. In Indonesia, the contingent comprised just three athletes. It increased to seven in China, but this time, only two athletes will be representing the country. Across the two editions, India has failed to win a medal in the discipline.

This time too, the chances seem slim. In the men's Speed 4 event, China's Shouhong Chu will be among the entries at the Asiad. Chu clinched gold at the Asian Championships earlier this year with a timing of 4.90s. In comparison, Deepu Mallesh (**in pic, left**) clocked 5.39s and 5.578s in qualification to finish 23rd. Moreover, reigning world champion Jianguo Long of China will also be in the fray. In the women's Speed 4 event, Indonesia's Desak Made Rita Kusuma Dewi boasts the Asian record of 6.07s, which she registered en route to the gold medal at the Asian Championships. Joga Purty (**in pic, right**) reached the Round of 16 at the Asian Championships but bowed out with a timing of 7.37s.

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SPORT CLIMBING

